Event held on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly's high-level segment

*Friday, 23 September 2022*
*Scandinavia House, New York City*

# EVENT REPORT

*Brussels and New York, October 2022*

This is a summary of the discussions held in the course of the day-long event entitled "Global Governance: Breaking Down or Breaking New Ground?" organized by the Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS) and the Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET). The event took place on 23 September 2022 at Scandinavia House in New York City, USA, on the sidelines of the "General Debate" (world leaders' segment) of the 77th Session of the United Nations General Assembly. Due to the application of the Chatham House Rule, no attribution is made to speakers and participants of the views they expressed but the key points raised are summarized under thematic categories.

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*This event was organised by the Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS) in association with the Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET), with the support of the Global Challenges Foundation (GCF)*

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# OVERVIEW

The event was co-organized and convened by the Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS) and the Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET), with support from the Global Challenges Foundation. The event's purpose was to consider whether global governance, as currently structured and practiced, is capable of effectively dealing with multiple and cascading environmental, economic, social and security crises, and if not, what can be done to address inefficiencies and gaps. Participants included representatives of governments, CSOs, academia, think tanks, former and current UN officials. To facilitate an open exchange of views without public attribution, the Chatham House Rule was observed.

The first part of the event considered ideas to strengthen the global governance architecture to effectively address existential threats to human security. Presentations were made on the UN Secretary-General's report "Our Common Agenda" (OCA) and its aftermath, the case for a Global Resilience Council (GRC), a UN Charter amendment and/or creative reinterpretation, and what is effective multilateralism. The second part discussed the war in Ukraine and what is being done about it. Presentations were heard on the implications of the war from a big-picture perspective, the role of the UN in the war thus far, a possible framework for negotiations, and the humanitarian and peace-building role of local and international civil society.

Participants overall agreed the current multilateral governance architecture is incapable of managing concurrent and multidimensional global crises, such as the COVID-19 pandemic, climate change, biodiversity loss and the food and energy insecurity exacerbated by the Russia-Ukraine war. Discussants proposed a number of solutions, ranging from amending the UN Charter using Article 109 to convene a Charter review conference, to making more practical adjustments to existing UN multilateral bodies and their *modus operandi*. Regardless of preference in terms of reform modalities, all agreed that a more agile, inclusive, equitable, people-cantered and "grounded-in-reality" global multilateral system is required.

With respect to the war in Ukraine, there was broad agreement that the UN Secretary-General (UNSG) had an important role to play in bringing it to an end. There were divergent views, however, on how exactly the UNSG should perform this role: whether he should remain impartial in order to broker a peace deal, or whether he should maintain a vocal stance against Russia given its breach of the UN Charter and international law.

While all agreed that aggression is unjustifiable, there were different views on the appropriate response to the Russian invasion of Ukraine. Some were of the view that condemning and isolating Russia was the only morally acceptable response, while others favored a more practical approach that would facilitate a "rapprochement" between the parties to end violence and destruction as soon as possible.

Throughout the event many highlighted the role that women, youth, local communities and other grass-root groups play in the attainment of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and indicated that they could also support humanitarian assistance and de-escalation of the Russia-Ukraine conflict through personal contact and communication on the ground and also at the negotiating table.

All concurred that the UN Summit for the Future, to be convened at the ministerial level in 2023 and at the Heads of State level in 2024,[1] is a prime opportunity to re-think, re-tool and re-skill the UN for today's challenges and tomorrow's opportunities. Reforming the UN to make it more effective and relevant is indispensable because of its unique legitimacy derived from the membership of 193 states.

The UN was formed to maintain international peace and security, to develop friendly relations among nations, and to promote social progress, better living standards and human rights. Looking retrospectively, in many ways the UN has fulfilled its promise because life expectancy and living conditions for many have improved since 1945, human rights are increasingly reflected in countries' legal frameworks, and a nuclear war has been averted – until now.

The threat of the escalation of the war in Ukraine is real, as the rapidly evolving situation is clearly demonstrating; and so are the consequences of climate change and increased biodiversity loss. The world is at grave risk, which is why we are at the threshold of another foundational moment for the UN and global governance – either we seize the opportunity to revive it now, or face potentially irreversible consequences for humanity and the planet in the years ahead.

The more detailed discussion summary that follows is presented in a thematic way without attribution to individual speakers or participants. For each issue, the summary distils the views expressed by the speakers in their initial presentations and their subsequent replies, as well as the comments made by participants.

# ***PART I***

## STRENGTHENING THE GLOBAL GOVERNANCE ARCHITECTURE TO EFFECTIVELY ADDRESS EXISTENTIAL THREATS TO HUMAN SECURITY

This session was moderated by Ms. María Fernanda Espinosa, Member, Global Women Leaders (GWL) Voices for Change and Inclusion, President of the 73rd Session of the UN General Assembly (UNGA), Former Foreign and Defense Minister of Ecuador. In her opening remarks Ms. Espinosa stated that UN reform had been a perennial topic, but noted that the UN was a living organism that had to evolve with the times, and said that we had reached tipping point with the multiple crises and the Russia-Ukraine war. She called for a major re-tooling of the system, noted that the adjustment curve needed to be steeper now that the world was facing "the perfect

[1] See UN General Assembly resolution on Modalities for the Summit of the Future, https://documents-dds-ny.un.org/doc/UNDOC/LTD/N22/581/18/PDF/N2258118.pdf?OpenElement

storm," and indicated that the Summit of the Future would be a prime opportunity to bring the UN up to par. She invited participants to put forth ideas on how this could come about.

The speakers for this session were (in alphabetical order):

> **Dr. Harris Gleckman**, Senior Fellow, Center on Governance and Sustainability, University of Massachusetts, Boston/Board Member, FOGGS
>
> **Dr. Richard Ponzio**, Senior Fellow and Director, Global Governance, Justice & Security Program, Stimson Center/Board Member, Academia Council on the United Nations System (ACUNS)
>
> **Dr. Vesselin Popovski**, Professor & Vice Dean/Executive Director, Centre for the Study of United Nations, Jindal Global University
>
> **Dr. Maria João Rodrigues**, President, Foundation for European Progressive Studies (FEPS)

**"Our Common Agenda" and the case for a Global Resilience Council**

Participants considered the UNSG's "Our Common Agenda" (OCA) report and noted some of the strengths and shortcomings in its approach to defining the role of the UN in upcoming years. The establishment of the UN Youth Office in the UN Secretariat, recently approved by the UN General Assembly (UNGA),[2] was hailed as a move in the right direction. However, proposals to outsource core UN functions to third parties and the private sector under the guise of "multi-stakeholderism" were acknowledged as moving in the wrong direction. In this regard, some discussants cautioned that governance without political leadership and accountability, consisting largely of voluntary guidelines for action by various actors, diffuses responsibility and accountability. Exclusively voluntary guidelines tend to reduce the efficacy of responses to the challenges at hand.

A distinction was made between "normal challenges", which largely fall under the terms of reference of existing international organizations, and a new kind of global threats or crises which are complex, multidimensional crises (CMDCs). These CMDCs have highly interconnected and mutually reinforcing causes and impacts.[3] Examples of these systemic, existential threats include climate change, increasing global inequalities, and the COVID-19 pandemic. As the world now faces this new type of crises, it is very appropriate to introduce a new international mechanism capable of managing them. The FOGGS proposal for a Global Resilience Council (GRC) was thus introduced, as a "UN Security Council" for major non-

[2] See A/RES/76/306, Establishment of the United Nations Youth Office, at https://daccess-ods.un.org/tmp/8501827.12078094.html.

[3] See slide presentation available online at https://www.foggs.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/10/GRC-Presentation_23-Sept-2022-event-ver3.pdf

military threats to human security. Such a Council could be established as a subsidiary body of the UN General Assembly, the intergovernmental assemblies of other UN system agencies and/or the Conferences of the Parties (COPs) to international agreements. In this way the Council would help in implementing system-wide solutions to threats originating in and/or touching upon various thematic areas.

The GRC would differ from the Emergency Platform proposed in the OCA in that it would be a standing body, flexible and inclusive, while being anchored in the authority and responsibility of state actors. The GRC would have the power to directly or indirectly impose sanctions and other types of measures in case of breach of international norms and rules. While being intergovernmental at its core, involving a representative number of states and state groups / regional integration organizations, it would closely and systematically engage constituencies of non-state actors like scientists, parliamentarians, local authorities, civil society organizations, the private sector, religious leaders and others. Each of these global constituencies would organize itself in an advisory assembly associated with the GRC, would both provide input towards the GRC decisions and undertake to do its part in the implementation of those decisions once taken.

Participants raised questions about the scope of power and authority of the GRC, such as who would define it and how. Would this require a UN Charter Amendment, could the Trusteeship Council or the Peacebuilding Commission be re-purposed for this type of function? Some inquired about how to strike the right balance between global governance and national sovereignty. Others questioned whether the creation of yet another body could solve inherent issues of lack of political will and leadership, distrust among UN Member States, bureaucratic siloes and turf wars among UN agencies and corresponding government ministries, and whether such a body would have the necessary knowledge and capabilities to address systemic issues and make evidence-based decisions. Questions were also raised about funding modalities for the GRC and how the input from different stakeholder assemblies would be conveyed to the GRC and reflected in decisions. The possibility was considered of an incremental approach, according to which the GRC concept could be tested through an existing body or through the establishment by the UNGA of a new subsidiary organ for the performance of the GRC functions, as per Article 22 of the UN Charter.

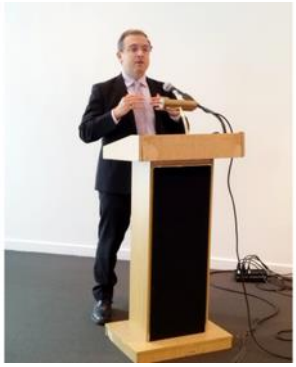
The 2030 Agenda was referenced as a valuable conceptual framework to guide the GRC's multidimensional work given the integrated and indivisible nature of the Sustainable Development Goals and targets. Further to a number of UN summits already planned for the period 2022 to 2025, notably on education (2022), the SDGs (2023), the future of global governance (2024) and social issues (2025), it was proposed that a series of major UN conferences like those of the 1990s should be convened in the coming years. This would be a way to reactivate civil society engagement with multilateralism around topics that have been disregarded thus far, such as regulating the Internet, the social, economic and ethical implications of AI autonomous decision-making, outer space and the role of caregivers in society.[4]

[4] See https://www.foggs.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/08/FOGGS-proposal-submitted-to-UN-HLAB-on-a-series-of-global-conferences-12-August-2022.pdf

**UN Charter Amendment and/or Creative Interpretation**

The war in Ukraine is clearly an institutional challenge to the UN. The UN Security Council's inability to act because of the veto power exercised by Russia is, for some, a clear sign that the UN needs radical reform. Initiatives like the one by Liechtenstein, which was endorsed by the UN General Assembly and now permanent members of the Security Council, are useful to make these members account for their use of the veto in front of the whole UN membership but may be insufficient to curtail indiscriminate use of the veto power in situations where there is a conflict of interest. Use of Article 109 that foresees the convening of a UN Charter review conference was discussed, with a view to eliminating the provisions for Security Council permanent membership and veto power, including a Council comprised of regional permanent members without veto power. Favoring this option, a participant noted that regional representation would satisfy, even if indirectly, the desire of many countries to have a permanent seat at the Security Council. Another option raised was having time-bound representation by major countries consisting in an 8-year term extendable for another 8 years.

There seemed to be consensus around the notion that the UN Security Council did not need more permanent members, nor additional veto powers, but rather the contrary. An extreme option referred to drafting an entirely new Charter and having a new world body initially adhered to by "democratic countries", eventually reaching universality through the gradual admittance of other countries that would accept the new Charter. The precedent of Germany and Japan, the defeated powers of World War II, not being members of the United Nations for decades was mentioned as proof of the workability of such an arrangement.



Questions were raised about whether UN reform would be possible given the likely objection to removing the veto power by the current Security Council permanent members. It was pointed out that for any amendment of the present Charter to enter into force the ratification by each and all of the current permanent members would be required (Article 108 of the UN Charter). Others pointed to the opportunity presented by the Summit of the Future in 2024 to re-assess the UN architecture in light of Article 22 (establishment of new subsidiary organs by the UNGA), and Article 109 (convening a review conference to amend the UN Charter by a 2/3 vote of the UNGA).

One participant, supported by others, noted that both tracks could be pursued simultaneously, but the ultimate objective ought to be keeping the peace, increasing humanity's and the planet's resilience and wellbeing, achieving equity and justice, and delivering on public goods. Some participants highlighted the need for inter-generational equity, addressing the inequalities among nations, and climate change justice. Participants agreed that in order for these objectives to be fulfilled, a transformational change was required, a whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach, with the active involvement and support of citizens / civil society, the private sector and the media, in addition to governments and intergovernmental bodies.

**What is effective multilateralism, what do we want to really achieve through it and how can we do it in practice?**

As part of the implementation of the proposals included in "Our Common Agenda", a High-level Advisory Board on Effective Multilateralism has been established by the UNSG and is expected to submit its recommendations by early 2023. But what is "effective multilateralism"? The European Union was brought up as a potential model of effective multilateralism that could provide tested precedents for UN reform, such as the existence of one intergovernmental council meeting with different compositions of ministers according to the various topics on the agenda (e.g. external relations, defense, trade, social issues, etc.) and deciding, depending on the topic, by unanimity, one-country-one-vote majority or weighted voting according to a country's population.

Questions about how to deal with new and evolving realities, such as a multi-polar world, cyber space and digital tools ought to be considered when embarking on the design of a revamped global multilateral architecture. Key concepts like "human security", the legal definition of war and peace, the role of the nation state, the role of gender in global governance, and "global citizenship" need to be rethought. For example, should intentional disruptions of essential supply chains or energy sources be considered as acts of war? How can we achieve sustainable development when most countries are experiencing imbalances in at least one of its three dimensions (economic, social, environmental)? How do we account for women's role in development given their valuable but often disregarded contributions? How do we realize gender equality? Questions like these should guide us to re-think the mission of the global multilateral system.

The EU and the rest of the West had a lot to offer in this regard but had to do it with full acknowledgement of their own past mistakes and present inconsistencies, and in a spirit of inclusiveness and solidarity. The preparatory process for the Summit of the Future offered a powerful opportunity to transform our global reality, and one of its main objectives ought to be new conceptual foundations for global governance and institutional reform.

Participants raised questions about the benefits of a weighted voting system vis-à-vis the more "democratic" scheme where all nations, big or small, had one vote and used consensus to reach common ground on many fronts. That said, already in the broader UN system there were weighted voting precedents, as in the Bretton Woods Institutions. Others noted that a single council charged with all matters could have unintended consequences in terms of concentration of power and undue delays as a result of a centralized bureaucracy out of touch with reality.

Participants also pointed to the need for a clear strategy for the series of UN summits from 2023 to 2025. One discussant said that the Summit of the Future ministerial meeting in 2023 and the 2023 SDG Summit ought to reaffirm the commitment towards achieving the SDGs and provide the necessary funding to this end,

while the actual Summit of the Future heads-of-state meeting in 2024 ought to decide on UN reform.

Some inquired about the precise meaning of the New Global Deal proposed by the UNSG in "Our Common Agenda". A participant pointed out that a deal is the outcome of a negotiation, where everyone has to give up something to get something in return, so it is not up to the UNSG or governments to decide on their own. So we should ask ourselves, what would the precise terms of a New Global Deal be and how should they be reached?

# ***PART II***

## THE RUSSIA-UKRAINE WAR AND WHAT IS BEING DONE ABOUT IT

This session was moderated by Dr. Tapio Kanninen**,** President, Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET) and former UN staff member, having served inter alia as Chief of Policy Planning at the Department of Political Affairs, UN Secretariat. In his opening remarks he stated that another major war on European soil was probably not something one would have expected well into the 21st century, certainly not one involving a permanent, veto-and-nuclear-weapons-armed member of the UN Security Council as the aggressor, with the defending country supported indirectly but clearly by three other veto-and-nuclear-weapon armed - Security Council members. He also referred to the current political atmosphere and public discussion in the West, where the mainstream view saw total military victory of Ukraine over Russia as the only solution for peace and objected to any negotiations with Russia. He asked the following questions: Can the world and multilateralism deal with this in the current global governance framework or are we already in World War III? What has the UN been doing and what more can be done to bring about a ceasefire and a process of peaceful conflict resolution?

The speakers for this session were:

> **Dr. Jeffrey Sachs**, Professor, and Director, Center for Sustainable Development, Columbia University
>
> **Dr. Georgios Kostakos**, Executive Director, FOGGS
>
> **Dr. Gary Slutkin**, MD, Founder and CEO, Cure Violence/Former Chief, Intervention, World Health Organization (WHO)
>
> **Ms. Felicity Gray**, Ukraine Director, Nonviolent Peaceforce

**Is this World War III? A big-picture perspective**

It was suggested that proactive and effective diplomacy could have prevented this war, and that it was a conflict long in the making. It could be seen as a tragedy that had been building for over 30 years. The "blame game" from the two sides would take us nowhere. Instead, communication should be re-established between the Parties, with an active role by the UNSG as an impartial and objective mediator, and the dissemination of more objective information on the causes and state of the conflict. Seeking the outright defeat of Russian President Putin meant "bringing an adversary to a humiliating retreat or nuclear war," as per US President John F. Kennedy's words during the Cuban missile crisis in the early 1960s. With this in mind, the only pathway towards a peaceful outcome was negotiation, not defeat of either party. It was therefore suggested that US President Biden's words at the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) on 21 September 2022 condemning and blaming Russia on all counts, was the kind of rhetoric likely to cause an escalation of the conflict with a risk of nuclear confrontation rather than to help end the conflict. In the end, some participants maintained that this was a proxy war between Russia and the US/NATO, and having two superpowers "at each other's throats" was unacceptable and dangerous.

The discussion among the participants demonstrated diverging views in terms of the need for and meaning of victory in the war. While some were of the view that victory from either side was not a necessity, others considered that only Ukraine's victory would provide grounds for lasting peace. Some noted the difference in the UN response to this conflict as compared to the 2003 US invasion of Iraq. A participant inquired how could these double standards co-exist under the same UN Charter. Many participants agreed about the need for immediate de-escalation of the Russia-Ukraine conflict and asked what could be done. The urgency of re-establishing communication between the parties, providing a space for negotiation based on objective information about the conflict, and putting in place a mediation/facilitation process was stressed.

**The role of the UN in the war thus far**

In spite of the declared focus on conflict prevention by the UN and its Secretary-General, the available diplomatic channels had not been used in a timely and effective fashion. For example, the UNSG could have visited Moscow and Kyiv long before the anticipated invasion. Moreover, the UNSG could have used his authority under Article 99 of the UN Charter to bring the situation to the attention of the Security Council before war broke out. The war might have been averted if the Security Council had intervened, but this was blocked by Russia's veto. The General Assembly could have asked the International Court of Justice for an advisory opinion on the applicability to a veto-holding permanent Council member of Article

27.3 of the UN Charter that requires a party to a dispute to abstain from voting, at least for decisions under Chapter VI of the Charter ("Pacific Settlement of Disputes").

The General Assembly did convene in an Emergency Special Session under the Uniting for Peace Resolution of 1950, in view of the Security Council's inability to act, but the couple of resolutions that the Assembly passed had no enforcement power. Heavy sanctions were imposed very quickly outside the UN framework by the US and the EU, but their efficacy was debatable and there had been negative unintended consequences for Europe in terms of the millions of Ukrainian refugees and energy insecurity, and for the world, in terms of availability and pricing of food and energy.

Some participants asked whether the UNSG could appoint an envoy for the Russia-Ukraine war and what would his/her terms of reference be. It was senior UN officials and Turkish diplomats who had in fact succeeded in getting the parties to agree on the safe resumption of trade in much-needed grains and fertilizers. The UN-brokered agreement to have experts from the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) stationed at the Zaporizhzhia nuclear power plant was also mentioned. One participant pointed out that when considering all of the options for addressing the Russia-Ukraine war, it was important to distinguish between international politics and international law, and the UNSG would have to combine both in a careful way to obtain a peaceful solution.

**A possible framework for negotiations**

Violence can be said to work and spread in the same way that epidemics do, with similar dire consequences to the lives, health and wellbeing of people. According to insights gained from working with communities afflicted by diseases like HIV/AIDs and violence, researchers had come to the conclusion that interventions to stop a communicable disease from spreading could also be used to stop incremental violence within a given community. Based on this research, a methodology had been developed for making effective interventions against community violence. The methodology was based on building trust and validating the grievances of all parties, as a means of establishing continuous contact and communication, diffusing tension, and enabling constructive dialogue. This methodology had been used successfully in several countries and could be used to stop the violence in the Russia-Ukraine war too. This would require identifying the right people on both ends, training them, and having an honest broker to facilitate the talks. The UNSG had the moral authority and the political standing to play this role.

Participants took a great interest in this novel approach and asked how the key people on both sides could be identified and trained, and how could the UN facilitate this approach. In response, it was said that the UNSG could use his diplomatic channels to identify the right people to work with and that the infrastructure would have to be set up with the assistance of experts. Once in place, though, this infrastructure could be used for similar purposes in the future.

**Local and International civil society and their humanitarian and peacebuilding role**

International non-governmental organizations (NGOs) have been connecting to and supporting local CSOs in Ukraine, as the most effective means of delivering humanitarian assistance, safely moving women and children away from the war zones, and relocating people from gravely damaged sites or sites contaminated from the use of explosives. Building the right network was the hardest part, but once established, the aid could be distributed more effectively and the responses made more timely. It was argued that the UN should involve local CSOs in its peacemaking and peacebuilding efforts, as a result of their proven efficacy on the ground. Reducing bureaucratic requirements, while still ensuring accountability by the recipient CSOs, would help improve UN – local CSO interaction.

## TO KEEP IN MIND ON THE WAY FORWARD

1. The **Summit of the Future** to be held in 2024 with its ministerial-level pre-meeting in 2023 was identified as a prime opportunity to re-think, re-tool and re-skill the UN for today's challenges and tomorrow's opportunities.
2. The **ministerial pre-meeting in 2023**, which will be held in tandem with the SDG Summit, should focus on setting principles and goal posts for the next phrase of global governance reform.
3. **The actual Summit of the Future in 2024** ought to decide on UN reforms needed to address the structural shortcomings of the global governance architecture, including the dysfunctionalities of the UN Security Council and the need for a new body to tackle today's multidimensional and interconnected crises.
4. **Preparatory sessions for the Summit of the Future** should consider different UN reform options and provide recommendations for adoption by the heads of state and government.
5. **Immediate action by the UN and the UNSG** is required to stop the war in Ukraine and mitigate its impact on civilians inside and outside of the country.
6. **The UNSG should have impartial information** about the origins and causes of the conflict, as well as the claims made by both parties, so as to discern the grounds on which each party stands and help identify some middle ground solutions.
7. **Re-establishing communication between the parties** is paramount: the UNSG could be informed about the lessons of community violence intervention programmes and the practical realities of using this approach in the Russia-Ukraine war.
8. Additionally, **the UNSG could appoint an envoy** to facilitate communication among the parties and between the respective parties and the UN.
9. **A longer-term solution** to avoid a replication of the Russia-Ukraine war should be sought, including the necessary infrastructure for intervention to end violence and UN Security Council reform.

*This event was organized by the Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS) in association with the Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET), with the support of the Global Challenges Foundation (GCF)*

# ANNEXES

- **Essential Reading**
- **Programme**
- **Moderators and Speakers**
- **List of Participants**
- **Organizing Team**

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# ESSENTIAL READING

## *PART I*

**UN SECRETARY-GENERAL'S REPORT "OUR COMMON AGENDA"**
Download the report (available in 6 languages)

**GLOBAL RESILIENCE COUNCIL (GRC): A 'SECURITY COUNCIL' FOR NON-MILITARY THREATS**
FOGGS webpage available in four languages **EN** **ES** **FR** **RU**

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**A GLOBAL RESILIENCE COUNCIL (GRC) TO EFFECTIVELY ADDRESS NON-MILITARY THREATS TO HUMAN SECURITY**
**Proposal submitted by FOGGS to the UN Secretary-General's High-level Advisory Board on Effective Multilateralism (HLAB)**, FOGGS, 12 August 2022
Download the proposal

**RE-OPEN THE GLOBAL GOVERNANCE DOORS THROUGH A SERIES OF GLOBAL CONFERENCES TO ADVANCE THE SDGS AND THE 2030 AGENDA**
**Proposal submitted by FOGGS to the UN Secretary-General's High-level Advisory Board on Effective Multilateralism (HLAB)**, FOGGS, 12 August 2022
Download the proposal

**ROAD TO 2023 – OUR COMMONG AGENDA AND THE PACT FOR THE FUTURE**
BY William Durch (Editor), Joris Larik, Richard Ponzio, Muznah Siddiqui, Nudhara Yusuf and Jerry Zhang, Global Governance Innovation Network / The Stimson Center, Washington, D.C., 17 June 2022
Download the paper

**WHY IS THE MULTILATERAL SYSTEM UNABLE TO EFFECTIVELY DEAL WITH GLOBAL HEALTH CRISES, AND WHY THERE IS A NEED FOR A GLOBAL RESILIENCE COUNCIL**
Lead Author: Neena Joshi, FOGGS, June 2022
Download the paper

**HOW IS THE MULTILATERAL SYSTEM FAILING TO DEAL WITH THE CLIMATE CRISIS, AND WHY THERE IS A NEED FOR A GLOBAL RESILIENCE COUNCIL**
By Stuart Best, FOGGS, April 2022
Download the paper

**GLOBAL GOVERNANCE AND 'OUR COMMON AGENDA': A CRITICAL REVIEW**
By Harris Gleckman & Georgios Kostakos, FOGGS, November 2021
Download the paper

**A 'SECURITY COUNCIL' TO DEAL WITH NON-MILITARY GLOBAL THREATS THE GLOBAL RESILIENCE COUNCIL REVISITED**
Lead Authors: Gleckman & Georgios Kostakos, FOGGS, June 2021
Download the paper

**A 'GLOBAL RESILIENCE COUNCIL': WHY AND IF YES, HOW? Brainstorming Note**
FOGGS, March 2021
Download the paper

# *PART II*

**THE CONFLICT IN UKRAINE: A POSSIBLE FRAMEWORK FOR NEGOTIATIONS**
From March to June 2022, a group of senior and experienced thinkers from Russia, Ukraine, Europe, the United States, and China has convened on a regular basis to discuss the conflict in Ukraine.
Download the documents

**THE KYIV SECURITY COMPACT INTERNATIONAL SECURITY GUARANTEES FOR UKRAINE: RECOMMENDATIONS**
Anders Fogh Rasmussen and Andrii Yermak, Co-Chairs of the Working Group On International Security Guarantees for Ukraine, Kyiv, 13 September 2022
Download the report

**UKRAINE IS THE LATEST NEOCON DISASTER**
By Jeffrey D. Sachs, *Other News*, 27 June 2022
Read the article

**IS A NEW CONFIDENCE-BUILDING ARCHITECTURE AND FUNDAMENTAL UN REFORM POSSIBLE AS A RESPONSE TO THE UKRAINE CRISIS?**
by Tapio Kanninen and Georgios Kostakos, *Other News*, 26 May 2022
Read the article

**PRELIMINARY FINDINGS CIVILIAN PROTECTION NEEDS & RESPONSES IN UKRAINE**
Nonviolent Peaceforce, May 2022
Download the report

**ANTÓNIO GUTERRES URGED TO TAKE LEAD IN SECURING PEACE IN UKRAINE OR RISK FUTURE OF UN**
Patrick Wintour, *The Guardian*, 19 April 2022
Read the article

**IF NOT NOW, WHEN? - AN OPEN LETTER TO INTERNATIONAL DONORS AND NGOS WHO WANT TO GENUINELY HELP UKRAINE**
National Network of Local Philanthropy Development, Undated
Read the letter

**Friday, 23 September 2022**

***Scandinavia House, New York City***

# PROGRAMME

***09:30 – 10:00 Arrival of Participants - Registration - Welcome Coffee***

**10:00 – 10:15 WELCOME BY THE ORGANIZERS**

***Mr. Richard Kinley**, President, Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS)*
***Dr. Tapio Kanninen**, President, Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET)*

**10:15 – 12:15 PART I: STRENGTHENING THE GLOBAL GOVERNANCE ARCHITECTURE TO EFFECTIVELY ADDRESS EXISTENTIAL THREATS TO HUMAN SECURITY**

Moderator: ***H.E. Ms. Maria Fernanda Espinosa**, Member, GWL Voices for Change and Inclusion / President of the 73rd Session of the UN General Assembly / Former Foreign and Defence Minister of Ecuador*

> *Reform has been a perennial item on the UN agenda, practically from the moment of its establishment in 1945. As a living organization it is natural for the world body to adjust to remain relevant and effective with the changing times. The adjustment curve needs to be steeper now, with the world facing the "perfect storm" of interconnected mega-crises, notably climate change, the COVID-19 pandemic, food, energy and water insecurity, along with shifting geopolitics and another major war in Europe. Is the UN able to transform itself to the inclusive and effective decision-making mechanism that the world needs today and tomorrow; and in what direction should this transformation move?*

- **OUR COMMON AGENDA AND ITS AFTERMATH**
  ***Dr. Richard Ponzio**, Senior Fellow and Director, Global Governance, Justice & Security Program, Stimson Center / Board Member, Academic Council on the United Nations System (ACUNS)*
- **THE CASE FOR A GLOBAL RESILIENCE COUNCIL**
  ***Dr. Harris Gleckman**, Senior Fellow, Center on Governance and Sustainability, U-Mass, Boston / Board Member, FOGGS*
- **UN CHARTER AMENDMENT AND/OR CREATIVE REINTERPRETATION?**
  ***Prof. (Dr.) Vesselin Popovski**, Professor & Vice Dean / Executive Director, Centre for the Study of United Nations, Jindal Global University* (via video link)
- **WHAT IS EFFECTIVE MULTILATERALISM? WHAT DO WE REALLY WANT TO ACHIEVE AND HOW CAN WE DO IT?**
  ***Prof. (Dr.) Maria João Rodrigues**, President, Foundation for European Progressive Studies (FEPS)*

***Q&A***

**12:15 – 14:00 Free time for Lunch**

## 14:00 – 16:00 PART II: THE RUSSIA-UKRAINE WAR AND WHAT IS BEING DONE ABOUT IT

*Moderator:* ***Dr. Tapio Kanninen****, President, Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET)*

*Another major war on European soil was probably not something one would have expected well into the 21st Century, certainly not one involving a permanent, veto- and nuclear-weapons-armed member of the UN Security Council as the aggressor, with the defending country supported indirectly but clearly by another three UN Security Council permanent, veto- and nuclear-weapons-armed members. Can the world and multilateralism deal with this within the current global governance framework or we are already in World War III? What has the UN being doing and what more can be done to bring about a ceasefire and a process of peaceful resolution? What is being done and what more can be done to empower the local population in Ukraine to cater for its humanitarian needs and help with the eventual process of healing?*

- **IS THIS WORLD WAR III? A BIG-PICTURE PERSPECTIVE**
  ***Prof. (Dr.) Jeffrey D. Sachs****, Director, Center for Sustainable Development, Columbia University* (via video link)
- **THE ROLE OF THE UN IN THE UKRAINE-RUSSIA WAR THUS FAR**
  ***Dr Georgios Kostakos****, Executive Director, FOGGS*
- **A POSSIBLE FRAMEWORK FOR NEGOTIATIONS**
  ***Dr. Gary Slutkin****, MD, Founder and CEO, Cure Violence / Former Chief, Intervention Development, World Health Organization (WHO)*
- **LOCAL AND INTERNATIONAL CIVIL SOCIETY AND THEIR HUMANITARIAN AND PEACEBUILDING ROLE**
  ***Ms. Felicity Gray,*** *Ukraine Director, Nonviolent Peaceforce* (via video link)

***Q&A***

## 16:00 – 16:15 CLOSING REMARKS BY THE ORGANIZERS

***Dr. Tapio Kanninen****, President, GCINET*
***Mr. Richard Kinley****, President, FOGGS*

***Organized by the Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS)***
***in association with the Global Crisis Information Network (GCINET)***
***with the support of the Global Challenges Foundation (GCF)***

# MODERATORS AND SPEAKERS

**H.E. Ms. Maria Fernanda Espinosa**, Member, GWL Voices for Change and Inclusion / President of the 73rd Session of the UN General Assembly / Former Foreign and Defence Minister of Ecuador

On 5 June 2018, the United Nations General Assembly elected Ecuadorean Foreign Minister María Fernanda Espinosa Garcés, as President of its 73rd session; only the fourth woman to hold that position in the history of the world body, and the first since 2006.

Ms Espinosa has more than 20 years of multilateral experience in international negotiations, peace, security, defence, disarmament, human rights, indigenous peoples, gender equality, sustainable development, environment, biodiversity, climate change and multilateral cooperation. She has served Ecuador as Minister of Foreign Affairs (twice), Minister of National Defence, and Coordinating Minister of Natural and Cultural Heritage.

In those capacities she coordinated the Sectorial Council on Foreign Policy and Promotion, which includes the Ministries of Tourism, Culture and Heritage, Foreign Trade, and the Environment. Ms. Espinosa was Chair of the Group of 77 and China until January 2018, and also served as Chair of the Andean Community. At the fifty-sixth session of the Commission on the Status of Women, she promoted the adoption of the resolution presented by Ecuador entitled "Indigenous women: key actors in poverty and hunger eradication". She was a chief negotiator at the sixteenth and seventeenth Conferences of the Parties of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change and at the Rio+20 United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development, where she facilitated the adoption of key elements in the outcome document entitled "The future we want".

**Dr. Harris Gleckman**, Senior Fellow, Center on Governance and Sustainability, U-Mass, Boston / Board Member, FOGGS

Harris Gleckman is the former Chief of the New York Office of the UN Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD), Senior Officer for the first Financing for Development Conference, and Chief of the Environmental Unit of the Centre on Transnational Corporations. Over a period of 30 years, he undertook policy-oriented research on multinational corporations, global environmental management, financing for development, global governance institutions, and the economics of climate change.

His academic background includes a Ph.D. in Sociology from Brandeis University, Waltham, MA 1980. (Political Economy of Food Production: A Case Study of the Sugar Industry); a M.A. in Sociology from Brandeis University, 1974; and a B.A. cum laude in Philosophy and Sociology from Brandeis University, 1968.

Dr. Gleckman is currently Senior Fellow at the Center for Governance and Sustainability, UMass-Boston and Director of Benchmark Environmental Consulting

**Ms. Felicity Gray**, Ukraine Director, Nonviolent Peaceforce

Since April 2022 Felicity Gray has been serving as Ukraine Director for humanitarian organisation Nonviolent Peaceforce.

Felicity Gray joined RegNet in 2017 to examine how nonviolent practices contribute to the protection of civilians in situations of violent conflict. The project explores the possibilities and limitations of alternative forms of nonviolent practice that are being used to protect civilians, with a particular focus on 'unarmed civilian protection' methodologies. She has a particular interest in the role this plays in the conflict in South Sudan.

Prior to joining RegNet, Felicity worked as a senior policy and parliamentary adviser to leaders of the Australian Greens, Senators Christine Milne and Richard Di Natale, with a focus on foreign affairs and parliamentary strategy. She has also worked as a research assistant to Professor Richard Eccleston at the University of Tasmania, publishing research focused on international tax transparency policy mechanisms.

Felicity holds a Masters in Participatory Development and Applied Anthropology from the ANU, specialising in humanitarian action. She also holds a Bachelor of Arts (First Class Honours) in history and international relations from the University of Tasmania, for which she received the University Medal.

**Dr. Tapio Kanninen**, President, Global Crisis Informant Network (GCIN)

Tapio Kanninen is President of New York based Global Crisis Informant Network Inc. He was Chief of the Policy Planning Unit in the UN Department of Political Affairs (1998-2005) and Head of the Secretariat of Kofi Annan's five Summits with Regional Organizations. Kanninen has worked on several UN reforms: as secretary and research focal point of the high-level drafting group of Boutros-Boutros Ghali's "An Agenda for Peace" and convener of the interdepartmental task force to implement its recommendations; secretary of General Assembly Working Groups on An Agenda for Peace; of Strengthening of the UN System; and of Security Council reform. He also worked as a team member of the UNEP-funded project in the UN Statistical Office to develop a global framework for environmental statistics.

Previously, Tapio served at the UN among other positions as Chief of Policy Planning at the Department of Political Affairs and Head of Secretariat of Kofi Annan's regional summits. He also worked for the UNEP-funded project establishing a global system of environmental statistics and at Finland's Statistical Agency. In 2013, Tapio wrote a history of the Club of Rome in his book "Crisis of Global Sustainability". Recently, he co-founded the Climate Leadership Council, an association of large Finnish corporations responding to threats of climate change and creating business opportunities for a carbon-free future.

**Mr. Richard Kinley, President, Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS)**

Richard Kinley was a senior official at the UN Climate Change Secretariat (UNFCCC) from 1993 to 2017. He served as Deputy Executive Secretary from 2006 to 2017 and was intimately involved in the development of UNFCCC as an organization from its establishment and in its management and operations. He also led or oversaw the secretariat's support to the climate change negotiations, including the Kyoto Protocol and the Paris Agreement, and to the intergovernmental institutions. Prior to joining UNFCCC, Richard was an official of the Government of Canada working on international environmental policy issues.

He holds a B.A. in political studies and an M.A. in international relations.

**Dr Georgios Kostakos**, Executive Director, Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability (FOGGS)

Dr Georgios Kostakos is co-founder and Executive Director of FOGGS with almost thirty years of work experience in international affairs, both as a practitioner and as a researcher.

His experience includes fourteen years with the United Nations, with assignments such as observing the elections that ended apartheid in South Africa (1994), promoting human rights in Haiti (1995), reporting from post-Dayton Bosnia (1996), serving as Assistant Secretary of the UN General Assembly's Committee on the Exercise of the Inalienable Rights of the Palestinian People (2000-2003), promoting UN strategic planning and reform as First Officer in the UN Secretary-General's Strategic Planning Unit (most of 2003-2006), organising the first ever high-level event on climate change in New York (2007), advancing the UN system delivering as one on climate change from the Secretariat of the UN System Chief Executives Board for Coordination (CEB, 2008-2009), laying the ground for the Sustainable Development Goals as Senior Adviser and Acting Deputy Executive Secretary of the UN Global Sustainability Panel (GSP, 2010-2012), supporting the negotiations that resulted in the Paris Agreement on Climate Change (UNFCCC COP21, 2015).

From November 2015 to August 2019 Georgios was Climate Action Thematic Coordinator at NEEMO EEIG, where he coordinated the monitoring of climate change adaptation and mitigation projects co-financed by the European Union's LIFE Programme. He has previously held numerous senior positions at the Hellenic Foundation for European and Foreign Policy (ELIAMEP), has organised postgraduate courses in international affairs at the University of Athens and has taught Global Governance and International Organisations to postgraduate students at the Brussels School of International Studies, University of Kent.

Georgios holds MA and PhD degrees in International Relations (Kent, UK), as well as an advanced degree in Mechanical Engineering (NTUA, Greece).

**Dr. Richard Ponzio**, Director, The Stimson Centre / Board Member, Academic Council on the United Nations System: (ACUNS)

Richard Ponzio is Director of the Global Governance, Justice & Security Program and a Senior Fellow at Stimson. Previously, he directed the Global Governance Program at The Hague Institute for Global Justice, where (in a partnership with Stimson) he served as Director for the Albright-Gambari Commission on Global Security, Justice & Governance. He brings expertise in the areas of global and national democratic institution-building, global political economy, South-Central Asia, and the role of international institutions in responding to state fragility, climate instability, global financial volatility, and population displacement.

Ponzio is formerly a Senior Adviser in the U.S. Department of State's Office of the Special Representative for Afghanistan and Pakistan, where he conceptualized and coordinated Secretary Hillary Clinton's and later John Kerry's New Silk Road initiative. Earlier he served as a Senior Strategy and Policy Officer in the State Department's Bureau of Conflict and Stabilization Operations, where he initiated a global network of multi/bilateral peacebuilding and stabilization organizations.

From 1999-2009, Ponzio served in a variety of senior policy and strategic planning positions for the United Nations in Afghanistan, Kosovo, Pakistan, Sierra Leone, the Solomon Islands, and New York. From 1997-1999, he was a Visiting Fulbright Fellow at the Mahbub ul Haq Human Development Centre in Islamabad, where his research focused on the governance-security-development nexus in South Asia.

Ponzio has published widely in academic and policy journals (including Global Governance, Foreign Policy, and Survival), edited volumes, newspapers, U.N. policy reports (including national, regional, and global Human Development Reports), and books, including Democratic Peacebuilding: Aiding Afghanistan and other Fragile States (OUP, 2011) and Human Development and Global Institutions: Evolution, Impact, and Reform (Routledge, January 2016, with Dr. Arunabha Ghosh). He serves on the board of the Academic Council on the UN System.

Ponzio completed his doctorate in politics and international relations at the University of Oxford on a Clarendon Scholarship and undertook earlier studies at The Fletcher School of Law & Diplomacy (M.A.), The Graduate Institute Geneva (M.A.) as a MacJannet Fellow, and Columbia University (B.A).

**Prof. Vesselin Popovski**, Professor & Vice Dean / Executive Director, Centre for the Study of United Nations, Jindal Global University

Vesselin Popovski is Professor & Vice Dean and Executive Director, Centre for the Study of United Nations, Jindal Global University

Before coming to India, between 2004 and 2014, Vesselin Popovski was Senior Academic Officer at the United Nations University in Tokyo. After 2007 he was Head of its Peace and Governance Programme, and after 2010 also Head of the UNU Press.

In 2002-2004 Popovski co-directed the European Union project 'Legal Protection of Individual Rights in Russian Federation', aimed at providing international legal know-how, training lawyers and human rights activists to apply the European and international human rights mechanisms, developing legal clinics and establishing new offices of the All-Russia Movement for Human Rights, equipping and capacitating them to protect the individual rights of citizens.

In 1999-2002 he was Assistant Professor at the University of Exeter and Co-Director of the Centre for European Studies. Undertaking research and teaching undergraduate and post-graduate courses on International Law, International Security, European Integration.

In 1996-1999 he was a Doctoral Student at King's College, London and simultaneously a Research Fellow at the NATO Academic Programme "Democratic Institutions".

In 1988-1996 he was a Bulgarian diplomat serving in Sofia, New York and London.

**Prof. (Dr.) Maria João Rodrigues**, President, Foundation for European Progressive Studies (FEPS)

Maria João Rodrigues – former Portuguese minister of Prime Minister Antonio Guterres, is a European politician with a long track in all European institutions: EU Presidencies, Council, European Council, European Commission and, more recently, European Parliament. She played a relevant role is several big European initiatives: the EU growth and jobs strategy, the Lisbon Treaty, the Eurozone reform, the European Social Pillar, the interface with EU external strategic partners and the Roadmap for EU's future.

Recently, she was Vice-President of S&D Group in the European Parliament, a parliamentary group with 189 members from all Member States, where she was in charge of the coordination of the parliamentary work and the inter-institutional negotiation on the EU agenda.

As an academic, she is full professor and was the Chair of the European Commission Board for socio-economic research. She has around one hundred publications and as expert and politician, has done more than two thousand conferences across Europe and the world.

**Prof. (Dr.) Jeffrey D. Sachs**, University Professor / Director, Center for Sustainable Development, Columbia University

Jeffrey D. Sachs is a world-renowned professor of economics, leader in sustainable development, senior UN advisor, bestselling author, and syndicated columnist whose monthly newspaper columns appear in more than 100 countries. He is the co-recipient of the 2015 Blue Planet Prize, the leading global prize for environmental leadership, and has twice been named among Time Magazine's 100 most influential world leaders.

Professor Sachs served as the Director of the Earth Institute at Columbia University from 2002 to 2016. During that time, he led a university-wide organization of more than 850 research scientists and policy experts in support of sustainable development, championed the Masters of Development Practice (MDP) program, which is now offered at 30 universities around the world, and helped to introduce the PhD in Sustainable Development at Columbia University. He was appointed University Professor at Columbia University in 2016 and also serves as Quetelet Professor of Sustainable Development and Professor of Health Policy and Management. He is Special Advisor to United Nations Secretary-General Ban Ki-moon on the Sustainable Development Goals, and previously advised both Secretary-General Ban Ki-moon and Secretary-General Kofi Annan on the Millennium Development Goals. He is a Distinguished Fellow of the International Institute of Applied Systems Analysis in Laxenburg, Austria.

Professor Sachs is widely considered to be one of the world's leading experts on economic development, global macroeconomics, and the fight against poverty. His work on ending poverty, overcoming macroeconomic instability, promoting economic growth, fighting hunger and disease, and promoting sustainable environmental practices has taken him to more than 125 countries. Over the past thirty years, he has advised dozens of heads of state and governments on economic strategy in the Americas, Europe, Asia, Africa, and the Middle East. He was among the outside advisors to Pope John Paul II on the encyclical Centesimus Annus and currently works closely with the Pontifical Academy of Sciences and the Pontifical Academy of Social Sciences on issues of sustainable development.

Prior to his arrival at Columbia University in July 2002, Professor Sachs spent over twenty years as a professor at Harvard University, where he served as the Director of the Center for International Development and the Galen L. Stone Professor of International Trade. Sachs was born in Detroit, Michigan, in 1954. He received his B.A., summa cum laude, from Harvard College in 1976, and his M.A. and Ph.D. from Harvard University in 1978 and 1980 respectively.

**Dr. Gary Slutkin**, MD, Founder and CEO of Cure Violence / Former Chief, Intervention Development, World Health Organization (WHO)

Gary Slutkin is founder, former CEO, and current board member of Cure Violence Global and credited with innovating the epidemic control approach to violence prevention. Gary is a physician and epidemiologist and has led efforts to combat epidemics of tuberculosis, cholera and AIDS. He worked in over 25 countries in east and central Africa, Latin America and Asia, consulted on SARS and Ebola, was the Director of Intervention for the World Health Organization and is currently tracking and advising governments on COVID19.

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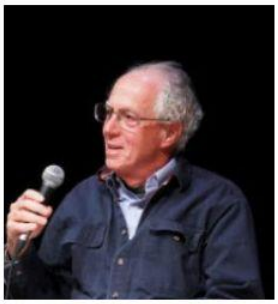

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